



PC Wall Mount

Paintings on the wall are fine, but what if we tell you that you could mount your PC components too?



Sony OLEDAffordable Attachable

Sony is preparing to launch a smart accessory at CES 2015 that turns your eyewear into a set of smart glasses

Inbox

From the past 5-6 months, there hasn't been one issue where I've tried hard not to tear anything apart while opening the package and removing those bits n' pieces of tape and yet failed I've miserably. Please don't give me that prices excuse. You already have almost increased it to 1.5 times in the past 9 years.

Now about the content: I am sorry but it is almost going down the drain. I was always excited to see what the Test Centre had for me this month. But not anymore. There was a time when you guys had reviewed 20-30 graphics cards, laptops, branded desktops, smartphones, digital cameras, hard disks and even ubiquitous things like headphones/earphones and pen drives. Now even Agent001 also does not cover any exciting products.

What went wrong? Is it a reflection of the declining state of the PC market that your June & December issues are barely anything more than the rest of the months? Back then (in 2003 or so) I was used to the idea of getting as many as 4-5 CDs with the December issue. This time I just got two. I have almost 2 to 3 drawers in my cabinet full of your CDs & DVDs.

Heck now even the writing team doesn't seem as enthusiastic to me. So many people just came and left - Deepak Ajwani, Sachin Kalbag, Robert Smith to mention a few. It's almost like being full of mid 90s kids who got an iPod / iPhone before they were 18, but are far less inclined to "actually" learn anything about tech like those kids of the 80s where it all started. They're more about show-off-cool-stuff-to-the-others who know the so-called status rise a tech product brings with it but not the value or the power that it has.

Over these 12 years I've also bought and seen off many other tech magazines simply to fulfill my tech appetite - PCQuest, IC Chip, PCWorld, Linux / Open Source For You. PC World and IC CHIP are dead now.

Then yours was a different product I used to wait for. Now it's just another one of those run-of-the-mill publications. Is this what success / lack of competition does to people? Now I need to know if you really want to improve the quality or will I have to wait for another publication to acquire you or take you over? Or is this a reflection of change in who's in command

- the flag-bearing company? 9.9 Media has disappointed me over Jasubhai Digital Media. Please accept your faults and truly take charge of what you're delivering to your readers.

Yours always,

- Siddharth

Hey Siddharth,

Just wanted to start by telling you I doubt anyone ever "leaves" a brand like Digit. However, since Digit still pays my salary, I most definitely haven't left... I may, at some point, stop being an employee of Digit, but it won't stop me being a reader...

We take the critical feedback far more seriously than we do the adulation, because that's what's kept us grounded all these years. We know we can always do better; always!

Let me address the very valid points you make in your criticism, and I'll be as straight-forward with my answers as you were with your email, because I think you'd expect that:

Packaging

Agree wholeheartedly. There's nothing more frustrating than ruining a magazine by tearing the cover. We will look into this once again to try and see what's going wrong. We buy the best 3M tape to prevent this from happening. We will try and get to the bottom of this once and for all. Thankfully the subscriber copies are saved from this headache.

Prices

This is a sore point. For you and for me. No one likes to pay extra, and yet no one likes to sell at a loss. Yes, we have, in 13 years, raised the price of the issue 100%. You tell me if you would work for 13 years at the same job and settle for only double the salary 13 years later? The other mags you mentioned were businesses first, this one isn't, which is why it's still alive.

Content

I agree. I loved the 30 GPU comparisons too. The 100 GPU comparisons even better, and the 30 CPUs, 65 HDDs, 40 inkjet printers... every single comparison was brilliant and diverse. Today, companies themselves aren't making that much variety for PC peripherals, and even if they're selling in

the market. For the non-PC stuff, there have been challenges with getting the products to come in on time, or at all. Some companies have decided to steer clear of comparisons. It's largely a dumb buyers market, and that's perfect for brands, and terrible for people like you and me (as tech enthusiasts). We are working on trying to change this.

CDs / DVDs

Sadly, this increasingly mobile-centric world of ours means that more and more Digit readers write in and tell us to do away with the DVDs altogether. We have to slowly but sadly accept the fact that we will have to disappoint the minority who still want them. Don't expect special issues in the future to be any different in terms of number of DVDs. :-)

Writing Style

Although subjective, yes I suppose you're right in the sense that the new generation of writers are those who have always had technology, and perhaps lack the emotional connect or the awe that we did when we started out. However, this does not mean nothing awes the new age writers... I still think we're quite in-depth and unswayed by fanboyism though; do you have any specific instances you would like me to clarify or look into?

The Rest

As for JDM and 9.9, trust me, it's just a perception you have. Digit has always been left to itself to run as a mag that's for enthusiasts, by enthusiasts. With 9.9 we went through a terrible recession, and I know first-hand how tough times got, but we functioned in a protective bubble, almost oblivious of the financial chaos all around.

This freedom that we've always been entrusted with also means that not only do we get to take credit for the adulation, we also have to accept the brickbats as well... it's NOT the company that's failed you, it's us, the editorial staff.

I really want to be able to wow you and readers like yourself again. I want you to be waiting eagerly for Digit again. Let's find a way to do that together... Maybe we can get a group of long-term readers like yourself together and have a reader meet, or make a small party of it all... What say?

- Robert